Coaching Codex





COACHING CODEX · GUIDE 06 · AI FOR MARKETING & SOCIAL CONTENT

AI for Local Marketing: Profile, Reviews & Posts

Get found by nearby customers. Write a fact-checked Google Business Profile description, reply to every review in your own voice, and plan one local post a week.

750	1	4
character profile description	review-reply bank	local posts a month

START HERE

Nearby customers are searching right now. Make sure they find you.

When someone searches “dentist near me” or “coffee near me”, Google often shows a map with a few local businesses. A complete, accurate, active profile gives you a better chance of being one of them. AI can do most of the writing. You supply the facts and do the checking.

PROFILE
Complete every field with confirmed facts

▶

REVIEWS
Ask politely, reply to every one

▶

POSTS
One short local update a week

What's inside

01 What a complete profile looks like p. 3

02 Write your business description p. 4

03 Services, products & common questions p. 5

04 Ask for reviews the right way p. 6

05 Your review-reply bank p. 7

06 Handle negative reviews calmly p. 8

07 Your monthly local-post plan p. 9

08 Your 7-day local marketing plan p. 10

A NOTE ON CHANGE

Google changes Business Profile features, menus and rules often. This guide focuses on **what to write and how to check it**, which stays useful. Always check Google's current help pages and policies.

Got this from a friend? Get more practical AI guides at shop-ds.github.io →

SECTION 01 · THE BASICS

What a complete Google Business Profile looks like

Google has said that complete, accurate information helps customers find you. Before writing anything clever, make sure the basics are filled in and correct.

Field	What good looks like	Done
Name	Your real business name only, no extra keywords	
Category	The one primary category that best describes you	
Address or service area	Exact address, or the towns you serve if you visit customers	
Hours	Regular hours plus holiday hours, kept up to date	
Phone & website	A number that is answered; a link that works on phones	
Description	Plain words: what you do, for whom, where (Section 02)	
Photos	Real photos of your place, team and work, added regularly	
Services / products	Your main offers with confirmed prices or “ask for a quote”	

PROMPT · PROFILE GAP CHECK

Here is the current text of my Google Business Profile: [PASTE NAME, CATEGORY, HOURS, DESCRIPTION, SERVICES].
List any fields that look missing, vague or inconsistent. Do not invent facts about my business. For each gap, tell me which fact I need to supply.

EXERCISE 1 · SEARCH LIKE A CUSTOMER (5 MINUTES)

On your phone, search for your main service plus “near me”. Write down the three businesses that appear first and one thing each profile does better than yours (more photos, recent replies, clear hours).

Got this from a friend? Get more practical AI guides at shop-ds.github.io →

SECTION 02 · DESCRIPTION

Write a business description customers actually read

The description field allows up to 750 characters (check the current limit). Most people only see the start, so lead with what you do, who it's for and where. No links, no offers, no keyword stuffing.

Include	Leave out
What you do, in customers' words	Prices and limited-time offers
Who you help and the area you serve	Website links and phone numbers
What makes you different (a fact, not a boast)	“Best in town” claims you can't prove
One practical detail (parking, booking, languages)	Lists of repeated keywords

PROMPT · PROFILE DESCRIPTION

Write a Google Business Profile description for my business, under 750 characters, in plain US English.
Business: [WHAT YOU DO AND WHERE]
Customers: [WHO YOU SERVE]
Confirmed facts that make us different: [FACTS]
Practical details: [PARKING, BOOKING, ACCESSIBILITY]
Use only these facts. No prices, links, offers or claims like “best”. If an essential fact is missing, ask me before drafting.

READ IT OUT LOUD

Read the draft aloud. If a sentence sounds like an ad rather than something you'd say to a customer at the counter, ask the AI to rewrite that sentence more plainly.

Got this from a friend? Get more practical AI guides at shop-ds.github.io →

SECTION 03 · SERVICES & QUESTIONS

Services, products and the questions people ask

Customers compare businesses on the map before they call. Clear service names, short descriptions and answers to common questions save them a phone call and save you time.

PROMPT · SERVICE DESCRIPTIONS

Write a short description (under 300 characters each) for these services: [SERVICE LIST].
For each, use only these confirmed details: [WHAT'S INCLUDED, TYPICAL DURATION, PRICE OR "QUOTE ON REQUEST"].
Do not add prices, durations or guarantees I haven't given. Ask me if something is missing.

PROMPT · COMMON QUESTIONS

Here are questions customers often ask us by phone or email: [LIST 5–8 QUESTIONS].
Here are the confirmed answers: [ANSWERS].
Rewrite each answer in 1–2 friendly sentences. Use only these answers; mark any question without an answer as [TO CONFIRM].

Where to use the answers depends on what your profile currently offers: the services section, your website's FAQ page, or a regular post. Google has changed or removed some question features in the past, so check what your profile shows today.

EXERCISE 2 · YOUR TOP 5 QUESTIONS

Write the five questions customers ask most often, with the confirmed answer next to each.

Got this from a friend? Get more practical AI guides at shop-ds.github.io →

SECTION 04 · ASKING FOR REVIEWS

Ask for reviews the right way

Many happy customers would leave a review if asked. They just forget. A short, friendly request with a direct link, sent soon after a good visit, is usually all it takes.

1. Copy your review link from your Business Profile (look for “Ask for reviews” or “Share review form”).
2. Ask in person first, at the moment the customer is pleased.
3. Follow up with a short message or a QR code card on the counter.
4. Ask everyone in the same way, not only the customers you expect to be happy.

PROMPT · REVIEW REQUEST MESSAGE

Write a short, friendly text message asking a customer to review [BUSINESS] on Google after their [SERVICE OR PURCHASE].
Include this link: [REVIEW LINK]. Under 40 words, no pressure, no discounts or gifts in return.
Use only these facts. Ask me if anything essential is missing.

NEVER BUY OR REWARD REVIEWS

Google's policies don't allow offering discounts, gifts or payment for reviews, asking only happy customers (“review gating”), or writing reviews for yourself. In the US the FTC also has rules against fake reviews and certain incentivized reviews, and other countries have similar consumer rules. Check the current policies; this is not legal advice.

Got this from a friend? Get more practical AI guides at shop-ds.github.io →

SECTION 05 · REPLY BANK

Your review-reply bank: reply to every review

Replies show future customers that a real person is listening. Keep them short, thank the reviewer, mention one specific thing they said and never copy-paste the same line every time.

Review type	A good reply does this
5 stars, detailed	Thank them, echo one detail, invite them back
5 stars, no text	Short thanks, one sentence, no essay
4 stars with a small complaint	Thank them, acknowledge the issue, say what you'll do (only if true)
Question inside a review	Answer with a confirmed fact or invite them to contact you

PROMPT · POSITIVE REVIEW REPLY

Write a reply to this Google review for [BUSINESS], under 60 words, in a [TONE] tone.
Review: "[PASTE REVIEW, REMOVE SURNAMES]"
Mention one specific thing the reviewer said. Use the reviewer's first name only if it appears in the review.
Do not invent offers, events or facts. If you need a fact, ask me.

EXERCISE 3 · BUILD YOUR BANK

Pick three real recent reviews (one 5-star, one short, one with a small complaint). Draft replies with the prompts, check them and save your best three as a reference for tone.

Got this from a friend? Get more practical AI guides at shop-ds.github.io →

SECTION 06 · NEGATIVE REVIEWS

Handle negative reviews calmly and in public

A calm, polite reply to a bad review is written for the next customer reading it, not only for the reviewer. Wait an hour, check your records, then reply.

1. Check what actually happened (booking, receipt, staff notes).
2. Thank them and acknowledge their experience, without arguing.
3. State only confirmed facts. Never share customer details in public.
4. Offer a way to continue privately (phone or email).
5. If the review breaks Google's policies (for example spam or not a real customer), use the report option instead of arguing.

PROMPT · NEGATIVE REVIEW REPLY

Write a calm, polite reply to this negative Google review, under 80 words.
Review: "[PASTE REVIEW, REMOVE NAMES AND DETAILS]"
What our records confirm: [FACTS]
What we can offer: [CONFIRMED NEXT STEP, E.G. CALL OUR MANAGER AT THE SHOP NUMBER]
Do not admit fault beyond these facts, argue, offer refunds or mention any personal details. If a fact is missing, ask me.

READ BEFORE YOU POST

Have a second person read negative-review replies before posting. Check that nothing reveals a customer's booking, health or order details.

Got this from a friend? Get more practical AI guides at shop-ds.github.io →

SECTION 07 · LOCAL POSTS

Your monthly local-post plan: one post a week

Business Profile posts (often called updates) appear on your profile and show you are active. Keep them short, add a real photo and one clear action, such as Call, Book or Learn more.

Week	Post idea	Example (fictional bakery in Denver)
1	Behind the scenes	Our 5 a.m. sourdough shift, with a photo of the oven
2	Product or service spotlight	This week's seasonal pie, with the confirmed price
3	Local tie-in	Open early for the neighborhood farmers market (confirmed date)
4	Helpful tip or common question	How to keep sourdough fresh for three days

PROMPT · MONTHLY POST PLAN

Plan four Google Business Profile posts for [BUSINESS] in [TOWN] for [MONTH].
Confirmed news, offers and dates: [FACTS]
Photos I have: [PHOTO LIST]
Each post: 2–4 short sentences and one call to action. Use only these facts; mark any idea that needs a fact as [TO CONFIRM].

BATCH IT

Write all four posts in one sitting at the start of the month, check them against your calendar, then post one each week. Time estimate: about 30 minutes for the month.

Got this from a friend? Get more practical AI guides at shop-ds.github.io →

SECTION 08 · HABIT

Your 7-day local marketing plan

One focused week sets up the profile. After that, about 15 minutes a week keeps it active.

Day	Action	Time (est.)	Done
1	Search like a customer; complete the field checklist	15 min	
2	Write and check your 750-character description	15 min	
3	Add services and your top 5 question answers	20 min	
4	Set up your review link and request message	10 min	
5	Reply to every unanswered review	20 min	
6	Plan this month's four posts; publish post 1	30 min	
7	Add 5 real photos; set a weekly 15-minute reminder	15 min	

Times are rough estimates and vary by business.

PROMPT · MONTHLY REVIEW

This month on my Google Business Profile I: [ACTIONS]. New reviews: [NUMBER FROM MY PROFILE].
Questions customers asked: [QUESTIONS].
Suggest 3 improvements for next month, using only these facts.

- [ ] Every fact on my profile matches my records
- [ ] No customer personal details in any reply
- [ ] I never offered anything in exchange for a review

Got this from a friend? Get more practical AI guides at shop-ds.github.io →

FIRST WIN · FICTIONAL EXAMPLE

Your first win, start to finish

Walk through replying to a 4-star Google review for Spoke & Chain, a made-up bike repair shop in Portland, Oregon. Nothing here is a real business, customer or review.

Example input	Value
Review (4 stars)	"Great tune-up, my bike rides like new. Only downside: I waited 20 minutes at pickup." – Dana
Confirmed facts	Tune-ups are booked online. From next Monday, pickups have a separate counter.
Tone	Friendly and short
Language	English

EXAMPLE COMPLETED PROMPT

Write a friendly English reply to this 4-star Google review for Spoke & Chain, a bike repair shop in Portland, Oregon. Under 60 words.

Review from Dana: "Great tune-up, my bike rides like new. Only downside: I waited 20 minutes at pickup."

Confirmed facts: from next Monday, pickups have a separate counter.

Thank Dana, mention the tune-up and acknowledge the wait. Use only these facts. Do not invent discounts, apologies on behalf of staff, or other changes. If an essential fact is missing, ask me before drafting.

Copy it, open your AI assistant (ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini or Copilot), paste and send. Then compare what you get with this:

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

Thanks, Dana! We're glad your bike rides like new after the tune-up. Sorry about the wait at pickup. From next Monday we'll have a separate pickup counter, so it should be quicker next time. See you on your next ride!

Checks before use

- [ ] The pickup-counter change and its date match the confirmed facts exactly.
- [ ] No discount, free service or other promise was added.
- [ ] It mentions something Dana actually said (the tune-up, the wait).
- [ ] It uses only the first name shown in the review and no other personal details.

USE IT

Copy the checked reply, open the review in your Google Business Profile and paste it as your reply yourself. The webpage does not post anything for you.

Got this from a friend? Get more practical AI guides at shop-ds.github.io →

GUIDED TASK

Reply to a Google review

When to use it: A new review arrives, positive or negative, and you want a short, calm reply in your own voice.
Prepare: The review text (remove surnames and personal details); What your records confirm about the visit; Any confirmed next step you can offer.

Question	Example answer
Describe your business in one sentence.	Spoke & Chain, a family-run bike repair shop in Portland, Oregon (fictional)
Paste the review.	"Lovely staff but my brakes squeaked again two days later." – Sam (3 stars)
What do your records confirm?	Brake adjustment done on Tuesday; free re-check is part of our service
What next step can you offer?	Bring the bike back any weekday for a free brake re-check
What tone should it use?	Calm, friendly and short
Which language should it be written in?	English

PROMPT TEMPLATE

Write a reply to this Google review, under 80 words.
Our business: [ABOUT YOUR BUSINESS]
Review: [REVIEW TEXT]
What our records confirm: [CONFIRMED FACTS]
Next step we can offer: [NEXT STEP]
Tone: [TONE]. Language: [LANGUAGE].
Thank the reviewer and mention one specific thing they said. Do not argue, admit fault beyond these facts, offer refunds or discounts, or mention any personal details. Use only these facts. If an essential fact is missing, ask me before drafting.

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

Thanks for the kind words about our team, Sam, and sorry the squeak came back. A free brake re-check is part of our service, so please bring the bike in any weekday and we'll take another look. We want every ride to feel right.

Checks before use

- [ ] Every fact and offer matches your records and what you will really do.
- [ ] No refund, discount or extra promise was added.
- [ ] No personal details beyond the first name shown in the review.
- [ ] It reads calmly to a future customer, not only to the reviewer.

Repairs

If...	Send this
Added a fact or promise	“Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else.”
Sounds defensive	“Rewrite this more calmly. Acknowledge the experience without arguing. Keep the facts unchanged.”
Too long	“Cut this to [NUMBER] words. Keep the thanks, the facts and the next step.”

Next action: Paste the checked reply under the review in your Business Profile yourself. For negative reviews, ask a second person to read it first.

Got this from a friend? Get more practical AI guides at shop-ds.github.io →

GUIDED TASK

Write your profile description

When to use it: Your Business Profile description is empty, vague or out of date. **Prepare:** What you do and the area you serve; Two or three facts that make you different; Practical details: booking, parking, accessibility.

Question	Example answer
Describe your business in one sentence.	Spoke & Chain, a family-run bike repair shop in Portland, Oregon (fictional)
Who are your typical customers?	Commuters, families and weekend riders in Southeast Portland
What confirmed facts make you different?	Same-day repairs for flat tires; we service e-bikes; family-run since 2012
Any practical details customers should know?	Book tune-ups online; bike parking out front; step-free entrance
Which language should it be written in?	English

PROMPT TEMPLATE

Write a Google Business Profile description, under 750 characters, in plain words.
Business: [ABOUT YOUR BUSINESS]
Customers: [CUSTOMERS]
Confirmed facts that make us different: [WHAT MAKES YOU DIFFERENT]
Practical details: [PRACTICAL DETAILS]
Language: [LANGUAGE].
Lead with what we do, for whom and where. No prices, links, offers, phone numbers or claims like “best”. Use only these facts. If an essential fact is missing, ask me before drafting.

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

Spoke & Chain is a family-run bike repair shop in Southeast Portland, fixing bikes since 2012 for commuters, families and weekend riders. We repair flat tires the same day and service e-bikes as well as regular bikes. Tune-ups can be booked online. You'll find bike parking out front and a step-free entrance.

Checks before use

- [ ] Every fact (year, services, same-day claim) matches your records.
- [ ] It is under 750 characters (paste it into a character counter).
- [ ] No prices, links, phone numbers or “best” claims.
- [ ] It reads like you talking, not like an ad.

Repairs

If...	Send this
Wrong or invented fact	“Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else.”
Too long	“Shorten this to under [NUMBER] characters. Keep the first sentence and every fact.”
Sounds like an ad	“Rewrite it in plain words, as if speaking to a customer at the counter. Keep every fact.”

Next action: Paste the checked description into the description field of your Business Profile and save. Update it whenever services change.

Got this from a friend? Get more practical AI guides at shop-ds.github.io →

GUIDED TASK

Plan a month of local posts

When to use it: At the start of each month, to keep your profile active with one post a week. **Prepare:** This month's confirmed news, offers and dates; A few real photos you can use.

Question	Example answer
Describe your business in one sentence.	Spoke & Chain, a family-run bike repair shop in Portland, Oregon (fictional)
Which month are you planning?	May
What confirmed news, offers or dates do you have?	Spring tune-up $65 (until May 31); open 8am on Bike to Work Day (May 15)
What photos do you have?	Workshop bench, a mechanic fixing a wheel, a row of repaired bikes
Which language should it be written in?	English

PROMPT TEMPLATE

Plan four short Google Business Profile posts, one per week, for [MONTH].
Our business: [ABOUT YOUR BUSINESS]
Confirmed news, offers and dates: [CONFIRMED NEWS & DATES]
Photos I have: [PHOTOS]
Language: [LANGUAGE].
Each post: 2–4 short sentences, one suggested photo and one call to action (Call, Book or Learn more). Use only these facts; mark any idea that needs a fact as [TO CONFIRM]. If an essential fact is missing, ask me.

ILLUSTRATIVE ANSWER, NOT A LIVE AI RESULT

Week 1: Spring tune-up is $65 until May 31. Get your bike ready for longer rides. Photo: workshop bench. CTA: Book. Week 2: Bike to Work Day is May 15, and we open at 8am. Photo: row of repaired bikes. CTA: Learn more. Week 3: Meet our mechanics at work. Photo: wheel repair. CTA: Call. Week 4: Tip: check tire pressure weekly. [TO CONFIRM: any extra news]. CTA: Book.

Checks before use

- [ ] Every price and date matches your confirmed news exactly.
- [ ] Offers end on the date you set, not later.
- [ ] Each post has one clear call to action.
- [ ] No idea depends on a fact you haven't confirmed.

Repairs

If...	Send this
Price or date changed	"Replace this assumption with the following confirmed fact: [FACT]. Change nothing else."
Invented event or offer	"Remove [IDEA]. We have not confirmed it. Replace it with a helpful tip instead."
Too salesy	"Rewrite post [NUMBER] as a helpful tip, with the call to action at the end."

Next action: Check the four posts against your calendar, then publish one each week from your Business Profile with a real photo.

Got this from a friend? Get more practical AI guides at shop-ds.github.io →

WHAT'S NEXT

You're on the map. Now keep customers coming back.

A complete profile, a reply bank and a weekly post: that's a local marketing routine you can keep up in minutes a week.

Write a Week of Social Media Posts in 30 Minutes with AI

Plan, write and schedule seven posts in one sitting.

Automate Your Inbox and Customer Replies with AI

Reply faster to the inquiries your profile brings in.

50 Copy-Paste AI Prompts for Small Business Owners

Fifty ready prompts for marketing, sales, service, admin and planning.

Make Scroll-Stopping Graphics with AI

Create simple images for your posts and profile.

Explore the Coaching Codex library →

Every guide comes with a free video walkthrough. Find the full library, bundles and new releases on the Coaching Codex website and our YouTube, TikTok and Instagram channels.

© 2026 Coaching Codex. For personal and internal business use. Please don't resell or redistribute this guide. This guide is general information, not legal advice. Google, Google Business Profile, Google Maps, ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini and Copilot are trademarks of their respective owners; Coaching Codex is not affiliated with them. Features, plans and prices change often; check each tool's current terms.

SHARED WITH YOU?

Liked this guide? There are more.

Coaching Codex publishes short, practical guides that help business owners use AI tools for real work: prompts, step-by-step setups and checklists you can use the same day.

Browse the Coaching Codex library →

shop-ds.github.io

USD 2.70
per guide. Instant PDF download after checkout.

USD 29
All-Access Library: every guide in the catalog in one purchase.

Scan to open the store

Reading this on paper or another screen? Point your phone camera at the code to open the catalog.

If a friend forwarded you this PDF, they thought it would help. Grab your own copy and the rest of the series from the store.